

Rome, Italy

Climate

Mediterranean with hot, dry summers around 31 C and mild, wetter winters near 12 C. Spring and autumn are pleasantly warm.

Best time to visit

April-June and September-October bring warm weather with more manageable crowds. July and August are very hot and crowded, and many locals leave the city in August.

Top attractions

The Colosseum and Roman Forum, Vatican City with St Peter's Basilica and the Sistine Chapel, the Pantheon, the Trevi Fountain, the Spanish Steps, and the lively Trastevere district.

Food

Roman pasta classics - carbonara, cacio e pepe and amatriciana - plus thin Roman pizza, suppli, espresso, and gelato. Save room for Roman-Jewish fried artichokes.

Visa & safety

Generally safe, with pickpockets working the major sites and the buses and metro toward Termini and the Vatican. Italy is in the Schengen Area - check the current entry requirements for your nationality before travel.